

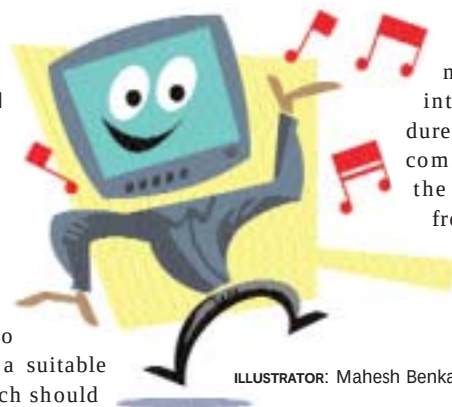
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Musical computer

Q, I have a Casio synthesizer with a midi port, and my computer has a sound card with midi/game port. How can I connect both of them to create great music?

Saurabh

A First you need to connect the two together with a suitable connector, which should have come bundled with your synthesizer—if it isn't, you'll have to buy one. You haven't specified whether your sound card is integrated or not; if the MIDI port is integrated into



ILLUSTRATOR: Mahesh Benkar

the motherboard, you'll need to check the BIOS (generally under Integrated Peripherals) to see whether the port is enabled and has an address. Next, you need to add the hardware into Windows. The procedure varies by OS version; a common method is to use the 'Add Hardware' wizard from the Control Panel.

Once the device is installed, check if it shows up in **Control Panel > Multimedia Devices**.

Finally, you'll need software that can handle an external synthesizer, such as Cakewalk, although there are plenty of alternatives. Now, you're all set to make cool digital music.

then restarts. The reason that appears for the restart is 'Drive Contents Changed'. This is really driving me mad. I run Windows Me. What should I do?

Dhananjay Gupta

A ScanDisk restarts when it detects a program writing to the disk. Therefore, before you start Scandisk, ensure that all other programs are closed—especially the ones in the System Tray, such as anti-virus programs, system monitors, firewalls, etc. You can press **[Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Delete]** to bring up the End Task box. This lets you see all programs currently running on your system.

If this fails to work, reboot into Safe Mode (press [F5] before Windows starts) and run ScanDisk. This will almost certainly solve the problem, but will make ScanDisk run rather slowly.

Intel or AMD?

Q, I have a Pentium III 800 MHz with 256 MB RAM. I want to upgrade my processor, as I can't run the latest games smoothly. Please suggest what I should buy—AMD or Intel? Is the latest software compatible with AMD processors?

Harsimranjit

A OK, we'll say it again: please write in and give us entire PC configurations if you want us to solve your problems properly. Now, since you haven't mentioned the most important gaming com-

ponent—the graphics card—we have to assume you don't have one. Instead of spending on a PC upgrade, you should buy yourself a good graphics card. For a Pentium III 800 MHz, a GeForce4 440MX or GeForce FX 5200 should do nicely. These cards cost about Rs 2,500 and Rs 5,000 respectively.

If you just have to upgrade, we suggest an AMD-nForce combination. This will save you money, as you will not have to buy a separate graphics card.

Three times the problem

Q, I have three questions:

Is there a way by which we can retrieve a forgotten password for a protected Excel worksheet?

Recently, I partitioned my hard disk on my home PC. I run Windows XP and Windows 98 SE. Is it possible to operate a Video Mate TV tuner card in Windows XP? I can't find the required Windows XP drivers. The instruction manual doesn't mention the manufacturer's Web site. Where can I find original or compatible drivers?

I am not able to type the '@' character. When I press it, I get an 'a'.

P. P. Chaukimath

A Yes, there are tools for recovering passwords of protected Excel files. One of them is Excel Key. A demo version can be downloaded from <http://www.lostpassword.com/excel.htm>. Another utility is Accent Office Password Recovery